

Super Moist Chocolate Cake

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

A soft, deeply chocolatey cake with a smooth cocoa frosting—simple to make and lovely to share.

Serves 8–10 · Prep 20 min · Cook 35 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CAKE

- 1 cup plain flour
- 1 cup sugar
- ¼ cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp baking powder
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 egg, at room temperature
- ½ cup vegetable oil
- ½ cup buttermilk, at room temperature
- ½ cup hot water

FOR THE FROSTING

- 5 tbsp butter, softened (approximately 70 g)
- ¼ cup unsweetened cocoa powder, sifted
- 1¼ cups icing sugar, sifted
- 3 tbsp milk
- ½ tsp vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Prepare the tin. Preheat the oven to 175°C. Grease a deep 20 cm round cake tin and line the base with baking paper.
2. Combine the dry ingredients. Whisk together the flour, sugar, cocoa powder, baking soda, baking powder and salt in a large bowl.
3. Add the wet ingredients. In a separate bowl, whisk together the egg, oil and buttermilk. Pour into the dry ingredients and mix until combined.
4. Add the hot water. Gradually pour in the hot water, whisking gently until the batter is smooth. It will be quite fluid.
5. Bake. Pour into the prepared tin and bake for approximately 30–35 minutes, checking from 30 minutes. The cake is ready when the centre springs back lightly and a skewer comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs. Allow additional time if needed.
6. Cool. Leave in the tin for 10–15 minutes, then carefully turn onto a wire rack. Cool completely before frosting.
7. Make the frosting. Beat the softened butter until creamy. Gradually add the sifted cocoa and icing sugar, alternating with the milk. Add the vanilla and beat until smooth and spreadable.
8. Finish. Place the cooled cake on a serving plate and spread the frosting generously over the top and sides.

Tip

Measure the flour lightly. Spoon it into the cup and level off without packing it down.

Watch Nell make it